

Word family: **estate / estates**

Base word: estate

Plural: estates

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> "...ride our bicycles around the housing **estate** until sunset."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **estate** means a **planned residential development containing a group of homes or apartment buildings, usually built and managed as one area**.

In Hong Kong and British-style English, **housing estate** commonly refers to a large residential complex or development.

繁體中文： **由多座住宅大樓或房屋組成、作為一個整體規劃和發展的住宅區 / 屋苑**

中文翻譯：

> "...ride our bicycles around the housing **estate** until sunset."

「.....還會在**屋苑 / 住宅區**裡踩單車，一直到太陽下山。」

Here:

housing estate = 由多座住宅及相關設施組成的一個規劃住宅區 / 屋苑

1. **estate = large area of land/property belonging to one owner (大片土地 / 物業) — 莊園 ; 地產 ; 大片私人土地**

This is one of the traditional core meanings.

Meaning: A large area of land, often containing a large house and other buildings, owned as one property.

Practice 1

> "The family owns a large country **estate**."

「這個家庭擁有一個大型鄉郊**莊園 / 地產**。」

Practice 2

> “The **estate** includes farmland, woodland, and several cottages.”

「這個**莊園 / 大片物業**包括農地、林地和幾間小屋。」

estate = 作為一個整體擁有和管理的一大片土地及其上的建築物

Common:

* country estate

* private estate

* landed estate

This is a physical property/land sense.

2. **housing estate / residential estate** (住宅發展) — 屋苑；住宅區

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A group of houses or apartment buildings planned and developed together as one residential area.

Practice 3 — Original

> “We rode our bicycles around the housing **estate** until sunset.”

「我們在**屋苑 / 住宅區**裡踩單車，一直到太陽下山。」

Practice 4

> “Thousands of families live on the **estate**.”

「數以千計的家庭住在這個**屋苑 / 住宅區**。」

Practice 5

> “The housing **estate** has its own shops and playgrounds.”

「這個**屋苑**有自己的商店和遊樂場。」

housing estate = 由多座住宅及相關設施組成、作為一個整體規劃發展的住宅區

This is especially common in British English and places influenced by British usage, including

Hong Kong.

3. **estate** = all money/property belonging to a person, especially after death (財產) — 遺產 ; 全部財產

This is a major legal/financial meaning.

Meaning: All the money, property, possessions, investments, and other assets belonging to a person, especially when discussing inheritance after that person dies.

Practice 6

> “His children inherited most of his **estate**.”

「他的子女繼承了他大部分的**遺產**。」

Practice 7

> “The lawyer was responsible for managing the **estate**.”

「律師負責管理該人的**遺產 / 全部財產**。」

estate = 某人擁有的全部財產、資產和物業，尤其指去世後需要處理或分配的遺產

This is clearly distinct from a housing estate.

4. **estate** = property/real-estate holdings (物業資產) — 地產 ; 物業

In business and property contexts, **estate** can refer to land and buildings as property.

Practice 8

> “Much of the company’s wealth is tied up in its property **estate**.”

「公司的大量財富都投放在其**地產 / 物業資產**中。」

Practice 9

> “The organization manages a large commercial **estate**.”

「這個機構管理大量商業**物業 / 地產資產**。」

****estate = 由土地、建築物和其他不動產構成的物業資產****

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but the emphasis is on ****property holdings**** rather than one traditional landed estate.

For database counting, I would usually merge it with the broader ****land/property**** sense.

5. ****industrial estate / business estate (工業 / 商業園區) — 工業區 ; 商業園區****

****Estate**** can also occur in planned developments for industry or business.

Practice 10

> “The factory is located on an industrial ****estate**** outside the city.”

「工廠位於市外的一個****工業區 / 工業園區****。」

Practice 11

> “Several technology companies have offices on the business ****estate****.”

「幾間科技公司都在這個****商業園區****設有辦公室。」

****industrial/business estate = 為工廠、辦公室或商業設施而整體規劃的一個發展區域****

This is structurally similar to:

> ****housing estate****

The use changes according to what the planned development contains.

For core counting, I would normally merge these under the broader:

> ****planned development/estate****

sense.

6. ****estate = social class/order, historical (社會階層) — 階層 ; 等級****

There is also a historical/social meaning of ****estate****, referring to one of the recognized classes or orders of society.

For example:

> **the three estates**

historically referred to social orders such as clergy, nobility, and common people.

Practice 12

> “Medieval society was divided into different **estates**.”

「中世紀社會被劃分成不同的**社會階層 / 等級**。」

Practice 13

> “The Third **Estate** represented the common people.”

「第三**階級 / 等級**代表平民。」

estate = 歷史上根據身分、權利或社會地位劃分的正式社會階層

This meaning is established, but for your learner-focused database I would mark it as **lower priority / historical**.

The Golden Manual says older meanings that remain encounterable may be mentioned with their status, but should not be presented as equally central modern everyday meanings.

Important distinction: **estate vs property**

property

is broader and can mean:

- * land
- * buildings
- * possessions
- * something legally owned.

estate

can specifically mean:

- * a large landed property;
- * a planned development;
- * a person's total assets, especially after death.

> “He owns a property.”

= 他擁有一項物業。

> “He owns a large estate.”

= 他擁有一大片地產 / 莊園。

So they overlap but are not interchangeable everywhere.

Important distinction: **estate vs housing estate**

estate

by itself can have several meanings.

housing estate

specifically means:

> a planned residential development

In your passage, the compound **housing estate** removes most ambiguity.

Important distinction: **estate vs neighbourhood**

housing estate

usually refers to a deliberately planned residential development.

neighbourhood

refers more broadly to the surrounding local area where people live.

A housing estate can form part of a larger neighbourhood.

So:

housing estate = 規劃住宅區 / 屋苑

neighbourhood = 附近社區 / 地區

Important distinction: **estate vs apartment complex**

These overlap in residential contexts.

housing estate

can contain:

- * many apartment blocks,
- * houses,
- * roads,
- * shops,
- * community facilities.

apartment complex

usually refers more narrowly to a group of apartment buildings.

In Hong Kong usage, **housing estate / estate** often corresponds naturally to:

> **屋苑**

Important distinction: **estate vs inheritance**

estate

= all property/assets belonging to a deceased person before or during distribution.

inheritance

= what an heir actually receives.

For example:

> “His estate was worth \$2 million.”

= 他的遺產總值二百萬元。

> “Her inheritance was \$500,000.”

= 她實際繼承了五十萬元。

So:

****estate = 遺產整體****

****inheritance = 某人繼承所得的部分 / 遺產****

Family-extension note

The practical morphological family is very small:

* ****estate****

* ****estates****

The learning value comes mainly from compounds and domain uses:

* housing estate

* country estate

* industrial estate

* business estate

* real estate

* estate planning

* estate tax

****real estate****

= land and buildings considered as property

> “She works in ****real estate****.”

「她從事****地產 / 房地產業****。」

****estate planning****

= arranging how someone's assets should be managed or distributed, especially after death

> “They spoke to a lawyer about ****estate planning****.”

「他們就****遺產規劃****向律師查詢。」

These are useful compounds rather than additional meanings of bare ****estate****.

The Golden Manual says useful compounds should be included where they add real learning value, without falsely treating each compound as a new lexical sense.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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estate — large landed property	作為一個整體擁有和管理的一大片土地，以及通常位於其上的住宅和其他建築物
housing/residential estate	由多座住宅及相關設施組成、作為一個整體規劃發展的住宅區 / 屋苑
estate — deceased person's assets	某人擁有的全部財產、資產和物業，尤其指去世後需要管理或分配的遺產
estate — property holdings	由土地、建築物及其他不動產構成的物業 / 地產資產；與 landed-property 義相關
industrial/business estate	為工廠、辦公室或商業設施整體規劃的一個發展園區
estate — historical social order	歷史上根據身分、權利和社會地位劃分的正式社會階層；較低優先度
real estate	土地及建築物作為財產 / 商品來看；房地產 / 地產

For your original sentence

> “...ride our bicycles around the housing ****estate**** until sunset.”

The exact meaning is:

****estate = 作為一個整體規劃和發展的住宅區****

More specifically:

****housing estate = 由多座住宅大樓、道路和相關公共 / 休閒設施組成的屋苑****

So:

> ****around the housing estate****

= ****在屋苑 / 住宅區裡四處****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful modern core meanings**** for ****estate****:

1. ****large landed property / group of property holdings****
2. ****planned residential, industrial, or business development****
3. ****a person's total assets/property, especially after death****

I would keep the historical ****social estate/class**** sense as a lower-priority note rather than part of the main modern learner count, and treat ****real estate, housing estate, industrial estate, estate planning**** as useful compounds under the relevant core meanings.